

Lecture 09

Health Informatics

Writing An Academic Email



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What is an email?

Email = e + mail = electronic mail

Is an electronic (digital) message transmitted via communication networks.



Formal

emails are used for business purposes, such as communicating with colleagues, clients, or customers. They should be written in a professional and respectful tone, using complete sentences and proper grammar. Avoid using contractions, slang, or emojis.

Formal

An email to a customer

A job application

An email to your manager

A complaint to a shop

An email from one company to another company

Informal

emails are used for personal communication, such as staying in touch with friends and family. They can be written in a more casual and relaxed tone, using contractions, slang, and emojis if appropriate

Informal

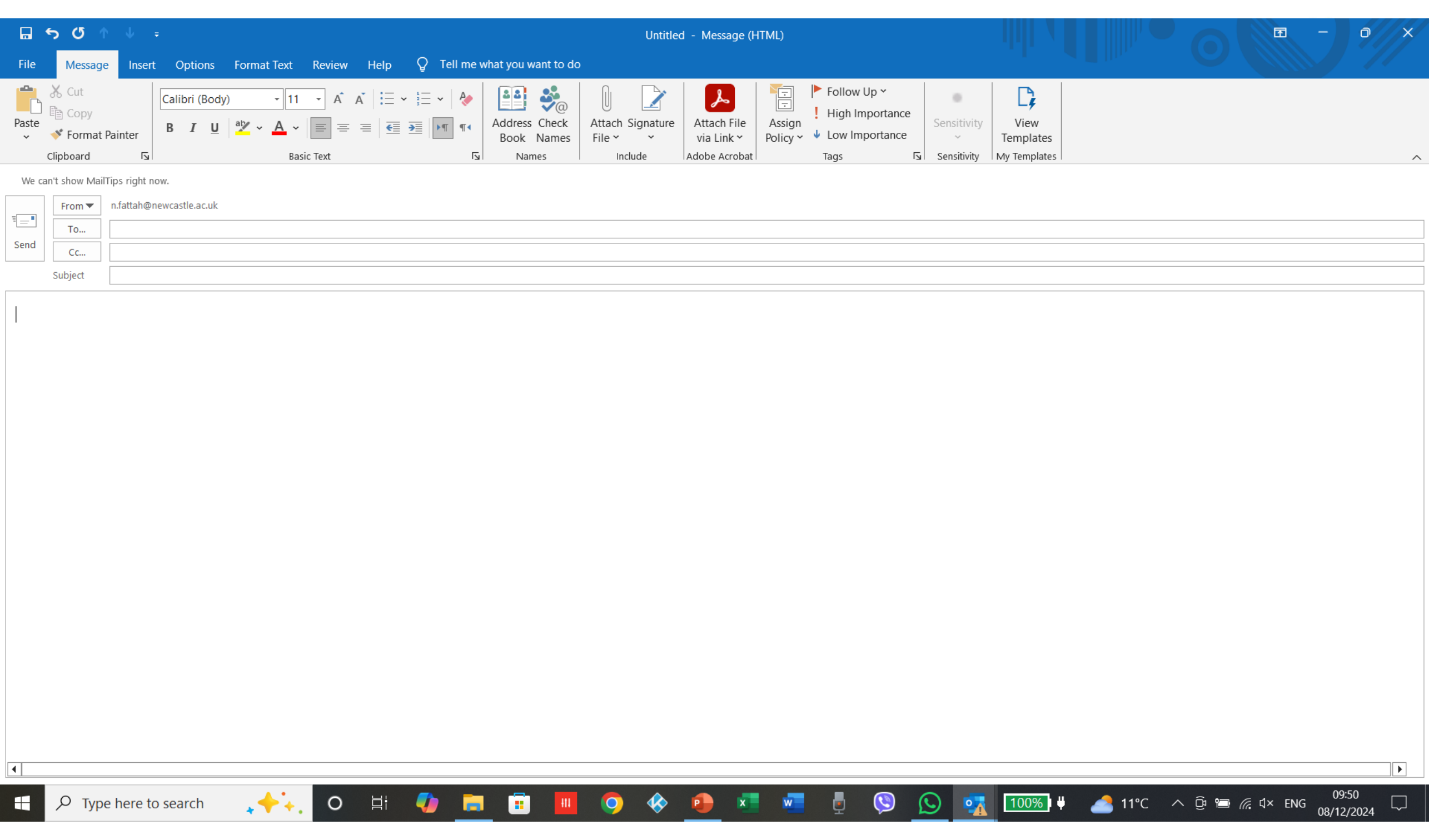
A birthday greeting to a colleague

An email to a colleague who is also a good friend

A social invitation to a friend at your workplace

An email with a link to a funny YouTube clip

A message to a friend on a social networking site



Parts of an Email

1. The address

- To: line
- CC: line
- BCC: line

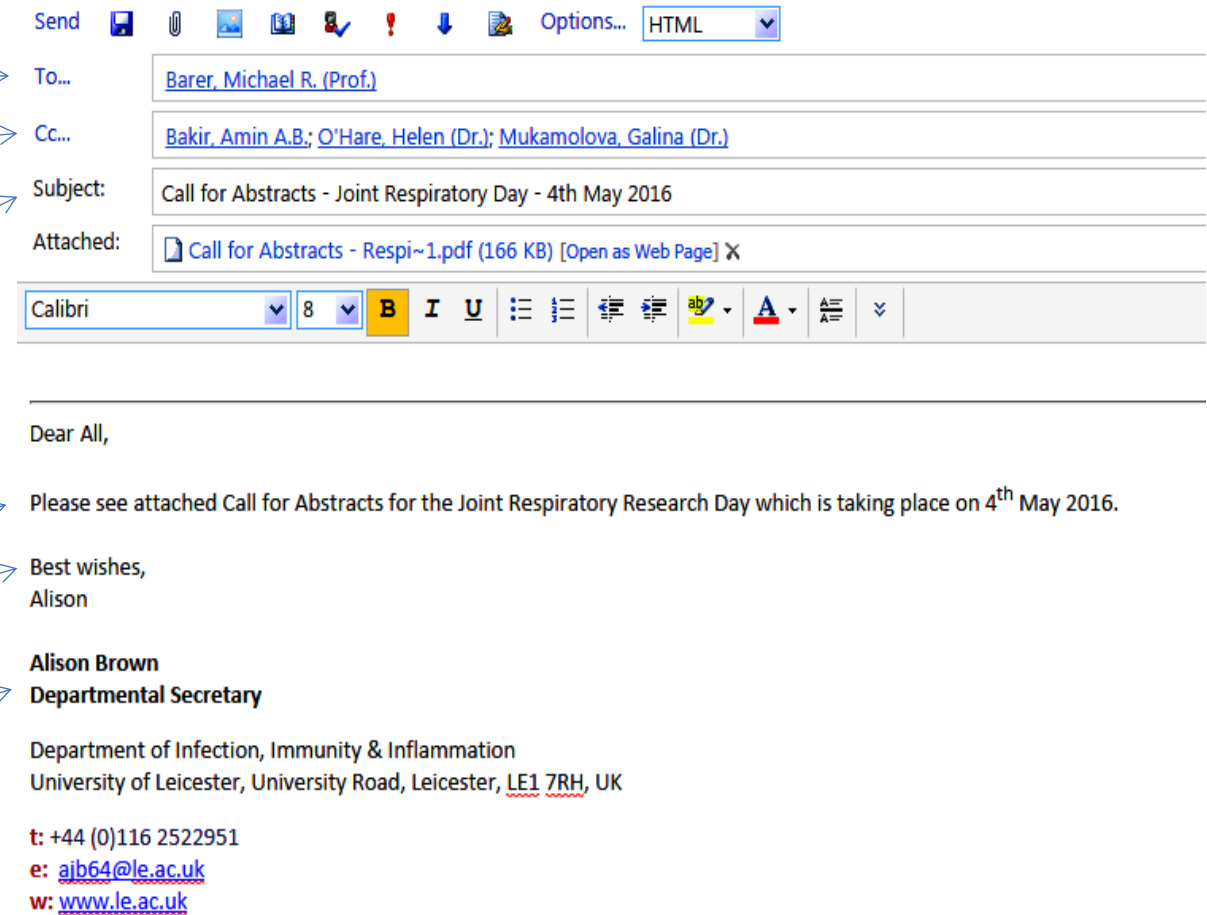
2. The subject line

3. The opening

4. The body of text

5. The closing

6. The signature



The To: line

- Recipient
- Usually the person directly involved in the communication
- Each individual on the **To** line is responsible for taking the action (or part of an action) outlined on the **Subject** line and the message relates directly to them.
- The **To** line and the **Subject** line are related.

The CC: Line

- CC stands for Carbon Copy
- “Send a copy of the message to an address other than the main recipient”
- No action or response is expected from individuals on the **Cc** line.
- Only to read or file the message.
- The individuals whose work is indirectly affected by the communication
- Any person added to the CC line can see the name and address of everybody else in the same email

The BCC: line

- **BCC** stands for Blind Carbon Copy
- Any name (address) entered on that line is completely hidden from view *'from everyone'*
- It's a way to protect the privacy of your recipients.

The subject line

The subject should clearly address the main point in your message

- Avoid sending an email with no subject
- Avoid subjects like:
 - x Hi
 - x Important

	Formal	Informal
Starting phrases	Dear Mr Piper, Dear Sir or Madam,	Hi Tim, Hi there Tim, Morning/Afternoon/Evening Tim, Hello again Tim,

Types of actions

- **Action** recipient has to perform a physical action.
- **Respond** recipient needs only to respond to your message
- **Read Only** recipient needs only to read your message
- **FYI Only** recipient needs only to file your message for future reference. Even reading the message is optional

The contents

- Identify the **type of action** that the recipient has to take after reading your message.
- Make it brief but informative
- If **multiple** individuals are responsible for different actions, clearly indicate who is responsible for what

The contents

- Do not write all in CAPITALS
- Do not use abbreviations like “4 u”, “Gr8”, “BTW”,...
- Do not use emoticons, jargons, slang
- Do not make short replies: “Thanks” only, or “Aha, OK”

The contents

Keep it short and get to the point

- Avoid long text
- Make it short paragraphs, up to 4
- If longer, put an attachment, accordingly

Here are some examples of formal and informal email sentences:

Formal:

- I would like to request a meeting to discuss the upcoming project.
- I am writing to follow up on my previous email regarding the job application.
- I am pleased to inform you that your proposal has been accepted.

Informal:

- Can we meet to discuss the upcoming project?
- Just following up on my previous email about the job application.
- Great news! Your proposal was accepted.

Closing remarks

- "Thank you for your patience and cooperation."
- "Thank you for your consideration."
- "If you have any questions or concerns, don't hesitate to let me know."
- "I look forward to hearing from you."

Signature

- Use an appropriate signature
- Brief (4-5 lines)
- Informative

provide all contact information

- Professional

do not include *pictures, quotes, animations*



Ending phrases	Yours sincerely, Yours faithfully, Yours truly,	Rgds, Cheers, Bye for now, See you soon,
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Before sending

- Use proper spelling, grammar & punctuation.
- Proofread
- Remember the emails are permanent
- Email reflect your personality
 - Don't be surprised if you're judged by the way you compose an email
 - If your email is littered with misspelled words and grammatical errors, you may be perceived as sloppy, careless, or even uneducated

Replying an email

- Send a prompt reply when necessary
- Up to 24-48 hours
- It is better to be within the same day
- If you needed time to gather information, consider sending a reply explaining the delay
- Include the sequence of previous emails (thread) in the reply email

Email Ethics

- Do not use email when a phone call or personal interview is a better choice
 - Sad news are more tolerable when received by call or face to face
- Be polite
- Do not use email to discuss confidential information
- Do not reply to a spam



Formal

Dear Mr Piper,
I am writing to thank you for all your help.
I look forward to seeing you next week.
With best wishes,
John Smith

Informal

Hi Tim,
Many thanks for your help.
See you next week.
Cheers,
Joh

Thank you

